

you may find yourself rushing to hospital, even though you are not yet in labor. You may also experience regular contractions for a period, which then stop. All of this is normal.

One sign that labor may be imminent is that you lose your mucus plug (see [The “bloody show”](#)); another is your water breaking. In some cases, however, neither of these events takes place until labor is established, so don’t panic if they don’t happen to you.

You’ll definitely know that you’re in labor when your contractions are occurring regularly, approximately every 15 minutes—time the gap between them. True contractions will get longer, stronger, and closer together as time goes on and won’t go away when you walk around or change position.